Scrubgnome-File

Twig's paperwork edition. Wipe the hidden diary out of your documents, PDFs and music before you send them.

> "Great gears! That document is gossiping about who wrote it, where it was saved and which printer it met. Hand it over." — Twig

Scrubgnome-File is the document member of the Scrubgnome family, alongside desktop Scrubgnome, the photo app Scrubgnome-Face and the video app Scrubgnome Away from Home. It does one job well:

1. **Pick** files (or *Share* them to "Scrub with Twig" from another app). One or a whole batch.
2. **See** what each one is leaking, in plain words: who, where, when, what with, and hidden extras.
3. **Scrub & save** clean copies (`Download/Scrubgnome/` on Android). Names that contain a date get a random one.
4. **Share / upload** the clean copies.

Two flavours, one brain: - **Android app**: install the APK. It's a thin shell around the web app below, with **no internet permission at all**. - **Web version for iPhone / any browser** (`web/`): open it in Safari, tap *Share* → *Add to Home Screen*, and it works like an app, even offline. The page's security policy forbids it from sending data anywhere.

What gets removed

File type	What Twig wipes
Word, Excel, PowerPoint	author, "last modified by", company, manager, editing time, template and save-folder paths (often containing your Windows user name), account e-mails, printer names, preview thumbnail, revision IDs that link drafts, and GPS/time in pasted photos
OpenDocument (LibreOffice)	the same kinds of things: author, dates, editing time, printer, thumbnail, pasted photos
PDF	document info (author, creator app, dates) in **every saved version**, XMP metadata, document IDs, annotation authors and dates, attached files and their names, and EXIF hidden in embedded photos
EPUB, ZIP	file dates and owner info inside the zip; everything inside is cleaned too
RTF, SVG	author/company blocks; editor names and file paths
MP3, M4A, FLAC, WAV, AIFF	artist, dates, location, encoder, comments, cover art
Photos	handed to Scrubgnome-Face's scrubber (GPS, time, phone, serials, thumbnails…)

Kept on purpose: comments and tracked changes stay in your document, but the names on them become "Author" and their dates are blanked. An e-book's own title and author are content, so they stay.

PDFs are cleaned in place: every hidden field is overwritten with a blank of exactly the same length, so nothing in the file moves and every page looks identical. If a PDF keeps personal fields in a compressed section that can't be edited that way (or is password-protected), Twig says so and won't

save a half-clean copy. Desktop Scrubgnome rewrites those fully. Same for PDFs with older saved versions: their hidden fields are cleaned, but desktop Scrubgnome is the one that drops the old versions entirely.

Not on the phone yet: OGG/Opus and WMA audio (desktop Scrubgnome does them). Videos go to Away from Home.

What it can't do: it removes *hidden* information only. A name typed in the text, a signature, or a logo on the page is still there, so give it a once-over.

After scrubbing, Twig re-scans every clean copy and refuses to save it if anything survived.

Install (no app store needed)

1. Open the repo's **Actions** tab → newest green **Build APK** run → download **ScrubgnomeFile-apk** (a zip holding the APK). Tagged versions also show up under **Releases**.
2. Copy the APK to your phone and tap it. Android will ask you to allow installs from that app (Files/Chrome). Allow it once.
3. Requires **Android 10 or newer** with an up-to-date Android System WebView (it updates through the Play Store).

iPhone / web version

1. Open the web app's address in Safari (published from this repo via GitHub Pages once the repo is public; see `.github/workflows/pages.yml`).
2. Tap **Share → Add to Home Screen**. Twig gets his own icon and works offline after the first visit.
3. **Pick files → Scrub all → Save / share → Save to Files**. Needs iOS 16.4 or newer (for the built-in zip support Office files use).

Build it yourself

Easiest: push to GitHub and let Actions build it (see `.github/workflows/build-apk.yml`). Release signing uses the same four repo secrets as the other Scrubgnome apps (`SG_KEYSTORE_B64`, `SG_KEYSTORE_PASS`, `SG_KEY_ALIAS`, `SG_KEY_PASS`). Without them you get a debug APK.

Android Studio: *File → Open* this folder, wait for Gradle sync, press ▶ with your phone plugged in.

Self-test (Node 22+ and Python 3, nothing else):

```
bash tools/selftest.sh     # scrub every sample in tools/samples, then verify independently
```

`tools/make_samples.py` regenerates the leaky samples (fake identity "Pat Example"; dev tools listed inside).

Project layout

```
web/                          ← the app (both flavours)
├── index.html                ← one screen
├── js/file.js                ← the scrubber core (all formats)
├── js/zip.js                 ← tiny zip reader/writer (neutral dates, no extras)
├── js/face.js                ← photo scrubber, from Scrubgnome-Face
├── js/mp4.js                 ← MP4/M4A scrubber, from Scrubgnome Away from Home
├── js/app.js                 ← UI glue, Twig's voice
└── sw.js, manifest.webmanifest
app/src/main/java/com/kultrshok/scrubgnome/file/MainActivity.java   ← Android WebView shell
tools/                        ← selftest.sh, selftest.mjs, verify.py, make_samples.py, samples/
```

No third-party libraries anywhere. `web/js/file.js` + `zip.js` drop straight into other projects.

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